

Sony SDM-N80 was the top scorer in the 18-inch category with an impressive 11.33 points. It showed practically no ghosting effect and its performance in the White and Black Level Shift test was excellent. On the other hand, Viewsonic VP 181 was not quite up to the mark. It scored just 8.66 points and we could see a lot of ghosting and streaking as well as a good deal of white and black level shift.

Screen uniformity

In the 15-inch category, Sharp LL-T15V1 showed a uniform screen throughout and it scored the highest (4 points). Philips 150 MT came close with a score of 3.67. Once again, LG Flatron 568 LM gave a poor showing with a meagre 1.87 points—the screen was not uniform and there was also some amount of flickering.

Viewsonic VE 170 MB performed well in the 17-inch category (3.5 points). Easel CT-170 and Samsung Syncmaster 171MP also gave an acceptable performance, scoring 2.33 and 3 points, respectively.

As for the 18-inch LCD monitors, the top scorers were Sony SDM-N80 (3.33 points) followed by Viewsonic VP181 (2.33 points).

Pixel Response Time

One of the few areas where LCDs really take a back seat is in the area of movies and games. But with faster pixel response times now becoming the norm, watching movies and playing games on LCDs is very much possible. Nevertheless, you can still observe a distinct blur in games and it can get a little strenuous on the eyes. We tested by playing a short clip from *The Matrix* where the scene changed frequently with lots of lights flashing. We also played the *Quake III* demo to gauge the performance of the LCD monitor when there were a lot of moving objects.

In the 15-inch category we found Sharp LL-T15V1 to be the best LCD with no ghost effect visible—it scored an impressive 6 points; compare that with the acceptable score which stands at 4.3 points. However, during the *Quake III* demo, we observed that while firing, the gun left behind a ghost image for a split second. However only a trained eye will catch this and most people will not notice any discrepancies.

We had a surprise winner in the 17-inch category—the Con-vergent monitor managed to

A Big Picture

LG Flatron 295 LM

LG Flatron 295LM was an LCD we recieved that had a massive 22-inch diagonal viewable area and an aspect ratio of 16:10. It had a soft-touch back-lit panel which made it very easy to operate the OSD. It also included features such as PiP (picture in picture) and with separate functions for PiP sound and image, this LCD makes sure that the image is crisp and crystal clear.

In our tests it performed brilliantly in the sharpness and resolution, colour and grayscale, and in the miscellaneous test. However, its performance was just about average in the pixel response time test—there was a noticeable blurring when play-



ing games. It fared above average in the image viewing test also. Even though one could not read the document on screen when viewed at an 80-degree angle, there was no different colour tinge to the screen. Overall, an excellent product.

Price: Rs 2,80,000

score 6 points. This LCD monitor was accurate in displaying images on the screen both while playing the movie and running the *Quake III* demo. There was no shadow left behind by fast moving objects even at high frame rates. Samsung SyncMaster 171MP was a close second in the race but there were some shadows left behind for split seconds in the *Quake III*.

Of the two LCDs in the 18-inch category, Viewsonic VP181 overtook Sony SDM-N80 by a good margin. The LCD from Sony was all right while playing the movie but in the game demo, the shadow was clearly visible.

The Features

In the 15-inch category, Philips 150MT was the most feature rich. Its power consumption was only 48 watts and it also provided the facility of adding a VCD, DVD and VCR player. It included a PiP (picture in picture) feature, enabling you



Sharp LL-T15V1 (15-inch LCD monitor)

to watch your favourite TV channel on your machine.

The stunning Samsung SyncMaster 151MP with its silver finish, would add grace to any desktop. It scored 18 points and also had the PiP feature along with a fully functional infra red remote control.

Among the 17-inch LCD monitors, LG Flatron 782LE logged a score of 19 points. It had a DVI interface for connecting the new-generation graphics cards. With a pixel pitch of 0.26 mm, it ensures a crisp display.

Viewsonic VP181 outsmarted its competitors in the 18-inch category. Its black finish made it stand apart. It had an easy-to-use OSD and five downstream USB and one upstream USB ports, which would allow users to connect various USB devices to it. For security, it also provides a Kensington notch and for Mac

Decision Maker		
	Office Productivity	Home, Internet and Entertainment
You need	A display that reproduces crisp text and office applications	A slim, smart looking display with support for a high resolution and excellent colour reproduction
Look for	15- or 17-inch LCDs	17- or 18-inch and above LCDs
The models	Philips 150MT, Sharp LL-T15S1, Viewsonic VE 170MP	Samsung SyncMaster 171MP, Sony SDM-N80
Price range	Up to Rs 45,000	Rs 50,000 and above